



KIPRE WORKSHOP FOR THE HUMAN RESOURCE ADVISORY COMMITTEE

Retreat Report

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Background and introduction

The Kenya Institute of Primate Research (KIPRE) Human Resource Advisory Committee (HRAC), with the approval of the Director General, held a working retreat at the Wildlife Research and Training Institute, Naivasha, from 14th to 24th June 2026.

The purpose of the retreat was to develop guiding principles for the transition of KIPRE staff from the human resource policies, instruments, grading structure, and terms of service currently administered under the National Museums of Kenya to those of the newly established Kenya Institute of Primate Research (KIPRE), a State Corporation (SAGA) under the Ministry of Health, State Department for Public Health and Professional Standards. The retreat also sought to lay the foundation for the development of KIPRE's independent human resource framework to support its operationalization following its delinking from the National Museums of Kenya.

Objectives of the retreat

1. Formulating the principles of transition.
2. Applying and validating those principles.
3. Identifying and resolving emerging issues and challenges.
4. Preparing and finalizing the transition report.

Attendance

The following were in attendance

	Name	Designation	Institution/Role
Resource Persons			
1.		DG/CEO	KIPRE
2.	Mr. Simon Indimuli, OGW, MBS	CEO/Secretary	State Corporations Advisory Committee (SCAC)
3.	Mr. Mutinda Muema	Director	SCAC
4.	Mrs. Cecilia Mbothu	Senior Governance Officer	SCAC
Committee Members			
5.	Dr. Peter Gichuhi Mwethera, PhD, MBS	DG/CEO	KIPRE
6.	Dr. Lucy Ochola, PhD	Chairperson	KIPRE
7.	Dr. Atunga Nyacheo, PhD, OGW	Member	KIPRE
8.	Dr. Jael Obiero, PhD	Member	KIPRE
9.	Mr. Patrick Manene	Member	KIPRE
10.	Dr. Mercy Akinyi, PhD	Member	KIPRE
11.	Dr. Danson Mwangi, PhD	Member	KIPRE
12.	Dr. Joseph Kamau, PhD	Member	KIPRE
13.	Dr. Stan Kivai, PhD	Member	KIPRE

14	Mrs. Maimuna Ahmed	Member	KIPRE
15	Mr. Daudi Salla	Member	KIPRE
16	Dr. George Omondi	Member	KIPRE
Secretariat/ Rapporteurs			
17	Mr. Patrick Mwaura	Secretariat/Rapporteur	KIPRE
18	Mr. Robert Origi	Secretariat/Rapporteur	KIPRE

Opening remarks

The retreat commenced with opening remarks delivered by Mr. Patrick Manene, who was standing in for the Chairperson of the Human Resource Management Committee (HRAC), Dr. Lucy Ochola, who was en route to the venue after attending an official conference.

Mr. Manene welcomed all participants and reiterated the purpose of the retreat, emphasizing the importance of developing guiding principles to facilitate the transition of KIPRE staff to the Institute's independent human resource framework following its delinking from the National Museums of Kenya.

He further explained the rationale for engaging the State Corporations Advisory Committee (SCAC), noting that the Committee's technical guidance was essential in ensuring that the staff rationalization process complied with government policies, public service regulations, and established best practices for State Corporations.

He urged members to undertake the assignment objectively, transparently, and collaboratively, with a view to developing a fair and practical transition framework that would support the successful operationalization of KIPRE as an autonomous State Corporation. He then formally welcomed the SCAC team and invited them to facilitate the technical sessions of the retreat.

Proceedings and deliberations

The technical sessions of the retreat were facilitated by the SCAC team, which outlined the objectives of the retreat from the perspective of the transition of KIPRE into an autonomous State Corporation. The team emphasized the need to undertake the staff transition process in a manner that was fair, transparent, compliant with government policy, and aligned with the approved KIPRE organizational structure.

To facilitate the exercise, SCAC presented a staff transition and placement template that would guide the rationalization process. The template captured information under the following broad areas:

Current status

- *Personal information (PF Number, Name and Date of Birth);*
- *Employment history (Date of first appointment, Designation and Grade at first appointment);*
- *Current employment details (Current designation, current grade, date of appointment to the current grade, years served in the current grade, academic and professional qualifications, terms of employment and current remuneration).*

Transition and placement

- *Proposed designation;*
- *Guiding principle used for conversion to the new designation;*
- *Proposed KIPRE job grade;*
- *Guiding principle used for conversion to the new grade;*
- *Proposed terms of appointment;*
- *Guiding principle for conversion of terms of service;*
- *Proposed basic salary and guiding principle used for salary conversion;*
- *Equivalent Civil Service grade for purposes of allowances; and*
- *Any additional remarks relevant to the transition.*

Following the presentation, members of the Human Resource Management Committee (HRMC) engaged the SCAC team in extensive discussions on various policy and implementation issues relating to staff transition. The key issues raised included:

The status of officers appointed to contractual administrative positions, such as Director and Deputy Director, and the position they would revert to upon expiry of their administrative contracts before attaining the mandatory retirement age.

Determination of the date of first appointment, particularly for staff who had previously served under fellowship arrangements, casual employment, volunteer engagements, or other non-established terms before formal appointment. Members also sought clarification on whether service in other organizations prior to joining KIPRE would be recognized during the transition process.

Retirement age and career progression for employees serving under the co-mandate as well as those serving in administrative and support functions.

Transition arrangements for employees who were initially appointed as Technicians or Laboratory Technologists but had subsequently acquired the qualifications necessary to serve as Scientists.

The principles to be applied in determining the appropriate KIPRE job grade for each member of staff during the transition process.

Key resolutions and recommendations

Following the deliberations, the SCAC team provided the following guidance:

Officers serving in contractual administrative positions will, upon expiry of their administrative contracts, revert to their substantive grades and continue serving the Institute until retirement or other lawful separation from service.

Service rendered under fellowship, casual, volunteer or other temporary engagements may be considered during staff placement, subject to the guiding principles that will be adopted by the Committee. However, for officers who served in other organizations before joining KIPRE, only the experience acquired while serving at KIPRE will be considered for purposes of placement under the transition framework.

On retirement age, members were advised that the Public Service Commission has issued the applicable policy guidance through existing circulars, which should guide the implementation process.

Employees who were initially appointed as Technicians or Laboratory Technologists but have since qualified to serve as Scientists will be considered in accordance with the approved transition principles. The SCAC team noted that the transition template specifically captures the designation at first appointment to facilitate such considerations.

Staff will generally transition laterally into equivalent grades within the KIPRE structure. However, two exceptions were noted:

Officers currently serving in NMK Grade NM8 will transition to KIP Grade 7, consistent with the KIPRE grading structure where degree holders enter at KIP Grade 7.

Officers currently serving in NMK Grade NM13 will transition to KIP Grade 12, since the KIPRE grading structure does not have an equivalent Grade 13. Consequently, officers in NM12 and NM13 will transition into the same KIP Grade 12.

The SCAC team emphasized that the transition process would be guided by legality, fairness, consistency, and adherence to the approved KIPRE organizational structure and applicable Government policies.

Way forward and action points

Action	Responsibility	Timeline
Apply the agreed transition principles to all staff records.	HRAC Secretariat	Immediate
Populate the staff transition template for all KIPRE employees.	HR Section	Within two weeks
Prepare the draft transition report for HRMC review.	Secretariat	As agreed
Submit the final transition report to the Director General and Board for consideration.	HRMC Chairperson	Upon completion

Conclusion

The retreat successfully achieved its objective of developing guiding principles to support the transition of KIPRE staff to the Institute's independent human resource framework. The deliberations and guidance provided by the State Corporations Advisory Committee (SCAC) established a foundation for the subsequent staff rationalization and placement exercise. The Committee expressed its appreciation to the Director General, the SCAC team, and all participants for their commitment and valuable contributions towards the success of the retreat.

Appendices

The guiding principles developed

TRANSITIONING STAFF OF KIPRE TO APPROVED HUMAN RESOURCE INSTRUMENTS

KIPRE 1. Staff shall transit from the current grading structure on horizontal/lateral basis to the approved structure as shown in table 1 below:

Table 1~ Lateral Conversion

CURRENT STATUS				NEW STATUS			
Current Grade NMK	Current Designation	Certification Cadre	Applying Salary Band	New Grade	New Designation	New Certification Cadre	Salary Scale to Apply KIP
1	DG/CEO	Degree	1	1	CEO/DG	Degree	1
2	Director	Degree	2	2	Director	Degree	2
	Chief Research Scientist	Degree	2	2	Chief Research Scientist		
3	Chief of Research	Degree	3	3	Deputy Director	Degree	3
	Principal Research Scientist	Degree	3	3	Senior Principal Research Scientist	Degree	3
4	Head of Department/Principal Administrative Officer/Senior Research Scientist [1]	Degree	4	4	Assistant Director	Degree	4
					Principal Research Scientist	Degree	4
5	Principal Officers/Senior Research Scientist [2]	Degree	5	5	Senior Research Scientist	Degree	5
					Principal Officer	Degree	5

6	Senior officers [1]/Research Scientist [1]	Degree	6	6	Research Scientist	Degree	6
					Senior Officer	Degree	6
7	Senior Officers [2]/Research Scientist [2]	Degree	7	7	Assistant Research Scientist	Degree	7
					Principal Technician Officer	Degree	7
					Principal Assistant Officer	Degree	7
					Principal Technician	Degree	7
8	Officers[2]/Assistant Research Scientist	Degree	8	8	Senior Technician	Diploma	8
					Senior Assistant Officer	Diploma	8
					Senior Technician	Diploma	8
9	Librarian [2]/Assistant Officer/Laboratory Technologist [2]	Diploma	9	9	Technician Assistant Officer	Diploma	9
					Technician	Diploma	9
					Principal Driver	Diploma	9
					Principal Craftsman	Diploma	9
10	Telephone Officer [1]/ Office Assistant [1]/ Human Resource Assistant	Diploma	10	10	Senior Driver	Craft Certificate	10

	[2]/Laboratory Technologist [3]/Senior Assistant [2]						
					Principal Office Assistant	Craft Certificate	10
					Principal Artisan	Craft Certificate	10
					Senior Craftsman	Craft Certificate	10
11	Telephone Officer [2]/ Higher Clerical Officer/ Office Assistant [2]/ Animal Health Assistant [1]/ Procurement Assistant [2]/ Artisan [2]	Certificate/KCSE/Craft	11	11	Driver	Craft Certificate/KCSE	11
					Senior Office Assistant	Craft Certificate/KCSE	11
					Senior Artisan	Craft Certificate/KCSE	11
					Craftsman	Craft Certificate/KCSE	11
12	Clerical Officer/ Animal Health Assistant [2]/ Assistant Transport Officer/ Office Assistant [2]/ Senior Auxiliary staff/ Driver Grade [2]/ Senior Security Guard/ Curatorial Assistant [3]/ Senior Security Guard/	KCSE/Craft	12	12	Office Assistant/ Artisan	KCSE	12
13	Auxiliary staff [1]/ Animal Health Assistant [3]/ Driver Grade [3]/ Auxiliary staff	KCSE	13				

	[1]/ Security Guard [1]/ CLARICAL OFFICER II						
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KIPRE 2. There will be no promotion due to current level of qualifications (degree, Diploma etc.) or for reason of any elongated stagnation in a grade except where the Cadre has been upgraded in the Approved Establishment;

KIPRE 3. There shall be no conversion of an Officer to a grade on account of similarity of designation in the new grading structure. Officers earn a grade and not a designation or title, hence no officer shall be downgraded.

KIPRE 4. Officers will on transition adopt the new designations assigned to their grades in the new dispensation.

KIPRE 5: Officers have been transited based on the career guidelines for each specific cadre.

KIPRE 6: Officers serving in grade NM 8 and who were appointed to that grade by dint of degree shall be automatically be upgraded to grade KIP 7.

KIPRE 7: Officers serving in grade NM 13 and NM 14 shall be automatically upgraded to grade KIP 12.

PRINCIPLES OF SALARY CONVERSION

KIPRE 8. Staff shall adopt the salaries applicable to their new grade. However where the current earning of a staff are above the maximum notch of the respective grade, then such staff would retain the salary on a personal-to-holder basis.

KIPRE 9. A staff whose salary is similar to a notch in the new salary structure shall adopt the new notch as entry salary.

KIPRE 10. A staff whose current salary has no equal notch in the new salary structure shall adopt the notch next to their current pay as the entry salary point.

KIPRE 11. A staff whose current salary is below the entry notch in the new higher grade shall adopt the entry notch of the higher grade as the entry salary point.

KIPRE 12. Allowances of an Officer will apply according to new grades. However, where the current allowances of an officer are higher than those of the new assigned grade, such an officer shall retain the current higher allowances on a personal-to-holder basis.

KIPRE 13. No consideration will be given to an officer's qualifications while converting laterally to the new grading.

KIPRE 14. Officers serving on P&P terms in new Grade KIPRE 4 to KIPRE 12 shall be retained on P&P terms.

KIPRE 15. Officers in new grade KIPRE 2 and KIPRE 3 but with less than five 5 years of service prior to retirement age may opt to remain on P & P terms subject to Board approval.

- KIPRE 16.** Where an Officers is converting laterally to a grade but there is no equivalent designation, nonetheless the officer will still convert to the grade and adopt a lower or higher designation within the cadre on a personal-to-holder basis.
- KIPRE 17.** Officers will adopt the respective allowances commensurate to their new grades.
- KIPRE 18.** Where an Officer has been wrongly graded outside the cadre's grading in the career guidelines, the officer shall be graded as per the cadre's career guidelines & incase the salary currently being earned is higher than the now appropriately assigned grade; then the Officer shall retain the prevailing perks on a personal-to-holder basis.

The Transitioning template

Attached in an excel file named: KIPRE - STAFF DATA CAPTURE_v1_21_06_2026.xls

The program of the retreat

Program (14th – 24th June, 2026)

DAY	TIME	ACTIVITY
Monday	8.00- 8.25 am	Registration
	8.25 – 8.30 am	Prayer
	8.30 – 8.50 am	Welcoming Remarks, Introduction of Participants
	8.50 – 9.00 am	Goodwill Remarks
	9.00 – 11.00 am	Formulating principles of transition
Monday	11.000 – 5.00 pm	Applying the Principles
Tuesday	9.00 – 1.00 pm	Applying the Principles
Tuesday	2.00 – 5.00 pm	Presentations of Applied Principles & Emerging Issues & Challenges
Wednesday	9.00 am – 5.00 pm	Applying Principles (Handling Immerging Issues)
Thursday	9.00 am – 12.00 noon	Applying Principles (Handling Immerging Issues)
Thursday	12.00 pm - 1.00 pm	Considering New Emerging Issues & Challenges
Thursday	2.00 pm - 5.00 pm	Applying Principles
Friday	9.00 am – 5.00 pm	Applying Principles
Monday	1.00pm – 2.00 pm	Applying Principles
Monday	2.00 pm - 4.00 pm	Guiding Preparation of Report
Tuesday	9.00 am – 5.00 pm	Preparation of the Report
Wednesday	9.00 am – 5.00 pm	Preparation of the Report
Thursday	9.00 am - 5.00 pm	Reviewing Report

Friday	9.00 am ~ 1.00 pm	Finalize report & Workshop Closure
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